ENG518 SHORT HANDOUTS MIDTERM

Lesson 06 to 10

(ENG518) Research Methodology

EFFORT BY VUHELPERS24 TEAM

REGARDS : SIR ZAHID: 03342743020

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Lesson-06

RESEARCH VARIABLES

Topic-026: Variables in a Hypothesis

What is a variable in research?

A variable is anything that has a quantity or quality that varies.

How is a hypothesis made testable in research?

A hypothesis is made testable by using operational definitions of variables and terms.

What are the characteristics of variables?

Variables can take different values and can increase or decrease over time.

List the types of variables.

Independent, Dependent, Moderator, Control (Intervening) variables.

What is the purpose of operational definitions in a hypothesis?

Operational definitions clarify terms used in the hypothesis, limit their meaning to the context, provide specific definitions, ensure statement clarity, and promote adherence to them.

Topic-027: Types of Variables

Define the independent variable.

The independent variable provides a stimulus, is measured, manipulated, or selected, and is the cause of change in a study.

What is the role of the dependent variable?

The dependent variable is responsible for the response or output in a study and is observed to be affected by the independent variable.

What is a moderator variable?

A moderator variable is a special type of independent variable that modifies the relationship between other variables.

Explain the control variable.

A control variable is an experimental element that remains constant and unchanged throughout the investigation to prevent its interference in the study.

What is an intervening variable?

An intervening variable is a hypothetical variable used to explain causal links between other variables. It cannot be observed in an experiment.

Topic-028: Research Variables Combined

How do variables interact in research?

Independent, moderator, and control variables can interact with each other in a research study.

In a hypothesis, what types of variables typically interact?

In a hypothesis, at least one independent variable and a dependent variable usually interact.

What are extraneous variables in a research context?

Extraneous variables are variables other than the independent variable that could influence the results of an experiment.

Provide an example of variables in a study and identify their types.

Among students of the same age and intelligence, skill performance is directly related to the number of practice traits, particularly among boys but less directly among girls.

Independent Variable: Number of practice traits

Dependent Variable: Skill performance

Moderator Variable: Sex

Control Variables: Age, intelligence

Intervening Variable: Learning (not stated)

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Lesson-07

HOW TO LOCATE RESEARCH?

Topic-029: How to Locate Research?

What are some sources for finding primary research?

Educational index, MLA/APA, ERIC.

Name some preliminary sources for research.

Educational Index, MLA/APA, CIJE, SSI (Social Sci. Index), ERIC/RIE.

What are secondary sources in research?

Secondary sources are references and summaries of primary research conducted by someone other than the original researchers.

How can you locate primary research from secondary sources?

Valuable places to find references to primary research are literature reviews, position papers, books, tables of references, and bibliographies.

Topic-030: Searching Answers for Your Questions

What is the importance of delimiting the research area when searching for answers?

Delimiting the research area helps narrow down the search and focus on specific topics of interest.

How can delimiter characters be used in advanced search techniques?

Delimiter characters mark the beginning or end of a data unit in advanced search, helping to refine search results.

How can specific keywords help in searching for research questions?

Specific keywords are essential for conducting effective searches and finding relevant research.

What is ERIC, and how can it be used for research?

ERIC is an online library of education research sponsored by the U.S. Department of Education. You can use ERIC to search for research in your area of interest by specifying keywords.

Topic-031: HTLR: Where to Look and What to Look For?

What is the main goal of primary research?

The main goal of primary research is to answer specific issues or questions, often involving questionnaires, surveys, or interviews.

How has technology changed the way primary research is conducted?

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Technology, such as PCs and the Internet, has made primary research more efficient by eliminating the need for physical libraries, writing, and carrying books.

Topic-032: HTLR: Preliminary Sources

How can resource materials from experts help in research?

Resource materials from experts provide valuable information and guidance for research.

Name some electronic databases that can be used for research.

Storehouses, CD-ROM, university library, HEC/other digital resources.

What are some keywords used as preliminary sources?

Keywords for preliminary sources can include terms from educational indexes, MLA/APA, ERIC, CIJE, and SSI (Social Sci. Index).

Topic-033: HTLR: Secondary Sources

What are literature reviews in research?

Literature reviews are summaries of existing literature and research, providing an overview of concepts and findings.

How are position papers similar to literature reviews?

Position papers are similar to literature reviews as they express concepts and provide insights into research findings.

Where can you find valuable references to primary research?

Valuable references to primary research can be found in books, tables of references, and bibliographies.

Lesson-08

LOCATING PRIMARY RESEARCH

Topic-034: (LPR) Locating Primary Research: Exploring Databases

What are preliminary sources that experts prepare to find research?

A: Preliminary sources prepared by experts can be found in bound copies in libraries.

What are some databases used to locate primary research, and where can they be accessed?

Databases like educational index, MLA/APA, ERIC/RIE, CIJE/LLBA/EI, and SSI (Social Sci. Index) are available to find research. They can be accessed on CDs/Databases, academic search premier, PsychInfo, Sociological abstracts, JSTOR, and www.eric.ed.gov.

Topic-035: LPR II: Examples

Name some options for locating primary research.

You can use options like ERIC, www.eric.ed.gov, JSTOR, and Google Scholar to locate primary research.

Topic-036: LPR: Position Papers vs Primary Research

What is a position paper, and how does it relate to primary research?

A position paper is a written report outlining someone's attitude or intentions regarding a particular matter. It is similar to a literature review and does not include primary research. It is used for proposing answers to research questions and generating hypotheses.

What should you avoid when dealing with position papers?

When dealing with position papers, you should avoid the trap of circular reasoning. Generating hypotheses is acceptable, but supporting and justifying is not. Position papers cannot substitute for a literature review.

Topic-037: LPR: Tables of References and Bibliographies

What should you consider when locating primary research?

When locating primary research, consider profitable places to find research studies, benchmark studies, studies with sparking interest in the area, particular issues, directional changes regarding the area, seminal studies, and tactics like identifying the frequency of citation, importance in the history of the area, and the area of investigation. You can also use Google Scholar.

Topic-038: LPR: Difference Between Primary & Secondary Sources

What are the two criteria to distinguish primary research from position papers?

The two criteria to distinguish primary research from position papers are whether the research is refereed (passed to a higher body for a decision) and whether it undergoes a blind review (the author's identity is hidden from the reviewer, and vice versa).

How are primary research and position papers different from each other?

Primary research and position papers are different in various aspects, including the title, terms, and techniques used. They must be known to active researchers.

Lesson-09

Exploring primary research in ELT

Topic 039: Obtaining ELT Related Research Articles

Where can research articles related to ELT be obtained?

Research articles related to ELT can be obtained from various sources, including university libraries, interlibrary loans, databases for small charges, HEC digital library, JSTOR, Google Scholar, and TESOL-specific resources.

Topic 040: Journals Related to ELT Research

What are some research journals that are relevant for ELT research?

Several research journals relevant to ELT research include TESOL, AAAL, IATEFL, AERA, and ESP journal.

Topic 041: Exploring ELT Research Journals

Name a few international journals that are valuable for ELT research.

International journals valuable for ELT research include TESOL, AAAL, IATEFL, AERA, and ESP journals.

What are some categories of journals to explore when conducting ELT research?

When exploring ELT research, you can consider categories like TESOL, AAAL, IATEFL, AERA, ESP journals, Pakistani journals, specific journals, and Appendix C of your course book.

Lesson-10

UNDERSTANDING WHERE DATA COME FROM?

Topic-042: Sampling Terminology

What is a population?

Population refers to the entire mass of observations or the universe, which includes all members of a group or objects.

What is a sample, and why is it used?

A sample is a subset of the population, drawn to test hypotheses. Samples are used because it's often impossible to access and study an entire population.

Can you provide examples of samples mentioned in the lesson?

Examples of samples include Su (2001) with 122 Chinese/English NSs and Borg (1998) who used one teacher as a sample.

What is the role of a sample in research?

Samples are the source of data used to answer research questions and contain the characteristics of a specific group, allowing the study of various attributes and features.

Topic-043: Sampling Paradigms

What are the two main sampling paradigms discussed in the lesson?

The two main sampling paradigms discussed are the Information Rich Paradigm and the Representative Sampling Paradigm.

What is the key focus of the Information Rich Paradigm?

The Information Rich Paradigm aims to uncover information through in-depth analysis, often used in qualitative research, with a focus on views, feelings, and holistic insights.

What is the primary characteristic of the Representative Sampling Paradigm?

The Representative Sampling Paradigm aims to create a replica of a larger group and is characterized by large samples that are generalizable, such as those used in questionnaires.

Topic-044: The Information-Rich Paradigm

What is the primary goal of qualitative sampling in the Information-Rich Paradigm?

The goal of qualitative sampling in the Information-Rich Paradigm is to maximize information while emphasizing the quality of information, not generalizing.

Can you provide an example of a small sample from the Information-Rich Paradigm?

Borg (1998) took one teacher as a sample, which is a very good example of a small sample.

What are examples of large samples mentioned in the lesson?

Examples of large samples include Guardado (2002) who studied six families and Spanish children in Canada.

Topic-045: Representative Sampling Paradigm

What is the main goal of the Representative Sampling Paradigm?

The main goal of the Representative Sampling Paradigm is to generalize findings. It aims to ensure that the selected samples represent important features of the population.

Why is it often impossible to study an entire population?

Access to the whole population is impossible in many cases, making sampling necessary for research.

Topic-046: Ethics in Sampling of Human Participants

What are some ethical issues related to sampling human participants?

Ethical issues related to human participants include the protection of their rights and privacy during research.

What are some guidelines for ethical sampling of human participants?

Researchers should obtain informed consent, ensure voluntary participation, provide information about the study's procedures, risks, and benefits, and be aware of exemptions for certain cases like educational/public behavior or public benefit/service.

Working on the Next Lessons

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